3. Collective Responsibility This is the bedrock principle of parliamentary government. The ministers are collectively responsible to the Parliament in general and to the Lok Sabha in particular (Article 75). They act as a team, and swim and sink together. The principle of collective responsibility implies that the Lok Sabha can remove the ministry (i.e., council of ministers headed by the Prime Minister) from office by passing a vote of no confidence.

4. Political Homogeneity Usually members of the council of ministers belong to the same political party, and hence they share the same political ideology. In case of coalition government, the ministers are bound by consensus.

5. Double Membership The ministers are members of both the legislature and the executive. This means that a person cannot be a minister without being a member of the Parliament. The Constitution stipulates that a minister who is not a member of the Parliament for a period of six consecutive months ceases to be a minister.

6. Leadership of the Prime Minister The Prime Minister plays the leadership role in this system of government. He/she is the leader of council of ministers, leader of the Parliament and leader of the party in power. In these capacities, he/she plays a significant and highly crucial role in the functioning of the government.

7. Dissolution of the Lower House The lower house of the Parliament (Lok Sabha) can be dissolved by the President on recommendation of the Prime Minister. In other words, the Prime Minister can advise the President to dissolve the Lok Sabha before the expiry of its term and hold fresh elections. This means that the executive enjoys the right to get the legislature dissolved in a parliamentary system.

8. Secrecy The ministers operate on the principle of secrecy of procedure and cannot divulge information about their proceedings, policies and decisions. They take the oath of secrecy before entering their office. The oath of secrecy to the ministers is administered by the President.

FEATURES OF PRESIDENTIAL GOVERNMENT

Unlike the Indian Constitution, the American Constitution provides for the presidential form of government. The features of the American presidential system of government are as follows:

1. The American President is both the head of the State and the head of government. As the head of State, he/she occupies a ceremonial position. As the head of government, he/she leads the executive organ of government.

2. The President is elected by an electoral college for a fixed tenure of four years. He/she cannot be removed by the Congress except by impeachment for a grave unconstitutional act.

3. The President governs with the help of a cabinet or a smaller body called ‘Kitchen Cabinet’. It is only an advisory body and consists of non-elected departmental secretaries. They are selected and appointed by him/her, are responsible only to him/her, and can be removed by him/her any time.

4. The President and his/her secretaries are not responsible to the Congress for their acts. They neither possess membership in the Congress nor attend its sessions.

5. The President cannot dissolve the House of Representatives—the lower house of the Congress.